

The Fan-Shaped Island: Dejima, Shintchi and the Nagasaki Hillsides

For two centuries a fan-shaped artificial island was Japan's only licensed door to the West, worked by Dutch clerks who could not leave it without a permit. Chinese merchants got a walled quarter of their own, and after 1859 new hillside settlements rose above the harbor. Reclamation later swallowed the island's shoreline; this dossier reads the fan, the quarter and the hillsides through what each left behind.



出島・新地・南山手（長崎市）

In this dossier

1. A history of the district (6 chapters, about 1800 words)
2. Timeline
3. Walking notes
4. Then and now: aerial photographs
5. How the ground was made
6. Disasters remembered
7. Sources (12) and further reading

Written in English from Japanese library sources — chiefly books digitised by the National Diet Library — and official records. Superscript numbers point to the numbered sources at the end, with page frames for the digitised books.

A narrow harbor and a fan of reclaimed land

Nagasaki sits in a deep, narrow inlet where steep hillsides run almost to the water, with the Nakashima River's floodplain the district's only sizeable flat stretch; much of the rest of the ground now built on was open water within the last few centuries. That combination — hills for houses, a harbor for ships, no room for either — shaped everything that follows. When the Portuguese needed housing kept apart from the town, and later when the Dutch, the Chinese and, after 1859, British and other foreign residents needed quarters of their own, Nagasaki's answer again and again was reclaimed land or a hillside no one else wanted.⁶

Dejima itself began that way. A Nagasaki place-name study of 1893 preserves the shogunate's own reasoning: in 1634 (Kan'ei 11) Edo judged it improper for Portuguese traders to keep living on their ships or scattered through the town, and ordered a residence built for them well away from it. Twenty-five townsmen took up the job at their own expense, planning to recover their costs by renting the finished buildings to the Portuguese, and petitioned the Nagasaki magistrate Sakakibara Hida-no-kami for a site: reclaimed ground in the sea off Edo-machi. Hundreds of laborers timed their work to the tides to raise it. The island that resulted, an artificial fan about 3,900 tsubo in area, was finished in 1636.¹⁶

A Portuguese island becomes a Dutch one

The Portuguese held Dejima for only three years. In 1637–38 the Shimabara Rebellion, a rising of persecuted Christians and hard-taxed farmers on the Shimabara peninsula, ended with the shogunate more convinced than ever that Christianity and foreign trade were the same danger; the Dutch East India Company's own factor supplied cannon to the besieging army, a service Edo did not forget. In August 1639 incoming Portuguese ships were told trade was over; when Macau sent an envoy ship the following year to plead for its restoration, sixty-one of its people were executed and the rest sent home with the news. Dejima stood empty.²

The Dutch inherited it not as a reward but as a further tightening of the leash. Their factory at Hirado had grown handsome enough — new stone warehouses in 1637 and 1639 carried their construction years in the Christian calendar cut into the gables — that the shogunate's inspector for Christian affairs, Inoue Chikugo-no-kami, ordered the offending buildings torn down in 1640 and more of them again that winter. In May 1641 a new factory chief, Maximiliaen Le Maire, was ordered to move the whole Dutch operation from Hirado into the vacant Portuguese compound at Nagasaki; the move was made that summer. From then until 1859 the Dutch East India Company, and after its collapse the Dutch state, held Dejima as Japan's only officially tolerated channel to the West — 218 years, by the island's own modern account.²⁶

Confinement was the point. The 1915 study drawing on the old Dutch factory records describes an island walled with wooden fencing, linked to the town by a single stone bridge with a guard hut at its foot, thirteen warning posts planted in the sea to keep boats out, and, inside, some sixty-five buildings — the factory chief's house, quarters for interpreters and Japanese overseers, warehouses, a garden, even livestock — for which the Company paid fifty-five kanme of silver a year in rent. Dutch staff needed permission to step outside the gate even to collect medicinal herbs, and their only regular news of the country beyond it came from the regular journey to pay respects to the shogun in Edo, made in a closed procession watched every step of the way.²

A walled quarter for the Chinese trade

China's merchants, oddly, had more freedom in Nagasaki for longer than the Dutch, and less afterward. Their trade goods had been stored since the seventeenth century in rented warehouses scattered through ordinary town wards — Edo-machi, Kabashima-machi, Goto-machi — until a fire in 1698 burned eighteen of the thirty-three of them along with twenty shiploads of Chinese cargo. The thirty-nine warehouse owners petitioned to rebuild away from the town on newly filled ground across

the water from Umegasaki; the work, costing more than 600 kanme of silver, most of it raised by the owners themselves, was finished in 1702. Seventy-five buildings stood on the reclaimed island, and its financiers, called Shinchi-tonin, gave the new land its lasting name: Shinchi, "new land," the name Nagasaki's Chinatown still carries.¹

The Chinese themselves were confined only from 1689, when the shogunate, having already restricted all Chinese trade to Nagasaki alone since 1635, built a walled compound of roughly 9,400 tsubo in what is now Tate-no-cho to end their mixing with the townspeople: moats, gates with guardhouses, and barracks that could hold about two thousand people at once. A fire in 1784 destroyed most of it, but afterward Chinese residents were allowed to rebuild in their own style; the surviving shrines trace their origins to that era, though their present buildings mostly date from further rebuildings between 1906 and 1977. A 1931 Nagasaki Prefecture survey of historic sites recorded, among the compound's remnants, a small Chinese-style shrine in Hiroba-machi known as the Ghost Hall, a brick Kannon hall in Tate-no-cho enshrining Kannon alongside the war god Guan Yu, and, on what had become the Yoshida family's property, one surviving leaf of the compound's inner gate, its transom carved with a plum-blossom pattern. Trade through the quarter withered after the port opened generally to foreigners in 1859, and the buildings burned down for good in 1870.³⁵¹¹

Hillsides for hire: Oura and Minamiyamate after 1859

The 1859 treaties opened Nagasaki to general foreign residence, but the shogunate at first confined the new settlement to Oura and the low ground nearby, leaving the healthier hillside above it, below Myogyo-ji temple, firmly withheld. A 1937 scholarly study of the settlement's changing maps confirms how little was there beforehand: before the settlement, the slope that became Minamiyamate held only a Suwa shrine outbuilding, Myogyo-ji itself, a hall called Nisshin-do and a guard post, while the broad, deep Oura inlet below it had houses along both banks that were later cleared for reclamation. Consuls pressed for two years for access to the slope, arguing the low ground was unhealthy and already overcrowded. The breakthrough came in mid-April 1861, when the British consul George S. Morrison, seated for the first time at the same table as the Nagasaki magistrate rather than across the room, argued that space was needed for residents' health and comfortable living, until the magistrate agreed, provisionally, to extend the settlement to the ground below Kotohira Shrine; Morrison reported the breakthrough to London in a despatch dated 13 April. About seventeen hectares were surveyed into thirty-five numbered lots of Minamiyamate. That October a young Scottish merchant, Thomas Blake Glover, took lot number three, a pine-covered rise with a view over the harbor.⁴⁸

Faith followed trade up the same slope. French missionary priests, allowed back into Japan under the new treaties, built a wooden church on the settlement's edge, finished on 29 December 1864 and consecrated the following February as Oura Church, in honor of the twenty-six Nagasaki martyrs of 1597. About a month later, in what its own custodians still call the central event in its history, one of a group of villagers from Urakami approached the French priest Bernard Petitjean inside the church and told him, in words the church's own history preserves, "We also hold the same faith as you do" — the first open sign, after two and a half centuries of prohibition, that a hidden Christian community had survived underground. The church was enlarged and unified in Gothic style in 1879, named a National Treasure in 1933, damaged by the atomic bomb in 1945 and restored by 1952, renamed a National Treasure again in 1953, and listed by UNESCO in 2018 among the Hidden Christian Sites in the Nagasaki Region.¹⁰

Reclaiming the island, and the war

Peacetime engineering did what neither fire nor treaty had: it erased Dejima's shape. The Nakashima River was rerouted in 1885, cutting away some eighteen meters from the island's northern edge, and further harbor improvement works filled in the surrounding water so completely that by 1904 the fan-shaped outline had vanished into the reclaimed shoreline, the island's site becoming ordinary city blocks indistinguishable from the land around them. What remained was designated a national historic site in 1922, but serious restoration did not begin until 1996, after decades of council reports and land purchases by the city; the first phase rebuilt about ten buildings, including the Dutch factory chief's residence and the water gate, on the island's west and north sides, and the city's stated long-term goal is to reopen water on every side of Dejima again.⁶⁷

The twentieth century's worst morning reached this district too, though its center fell elsewhere. At 11:02 a.m. on 9 August 1945, an American B-29 released an atomic bomb that detonated roughly 500 meters above Matsuyama-cho, some 500 to 600 meters north of the target zone around the Mitsubishi steel and arms works that the crew, finding a gap in the clouds, had chosen at the last minute; the official hypocenter today lies, by this dossier's own reckoning from the site's published coordinates, about three and a half kilometers north of Dejima, on the far side of the hills that separate the Nakashima valley from Urakami. Those hills did not spare this district entirely: an association history of Nagasaki's Chinatown records that of the old Chinese-quarter buildings still standing in 1945, only the gate and the Tenko-do shrine of the Fujian merchants' assembly hall survived the bomb's blast and fire. This dossier's companion Basic brief sets out the district's own war-related memorials in full. ⁹¹¹

A flood, a bridge and the ground today

The Nakashima River, so useful for reclaiming land, turned violent on 23 July 1982, when a cloudburst dropped as much as 187 mm of rain in a single hour on Nagayo, just north of the city — still, by one specialist account, Japan's highest recorded hourly rainfall — and set off landslides that caused most of the disaster's deaths; this dossier's companion Basic brief gives the city's own casualty figures for the flood. Of the fourteen historic stone bridges spanning the Nakashima River, six were swept away outright and three more seriously damaged, and prefectural and national planners initially proposed clearing the survivors rather than rebuilding them. A campaign led by the planner Katayose Toshihide and local residents argued successfully for restoration instead, and by 1986 the damaged bridges, among them the Higashi-shin Bridge, had been rebuilt using stones recovered from the riverbed. ¹²

Megane-bashi, the arched Spectacles Bridge a short walk upstream, is the oldest of them by far: built in 1634, the same year Dejima was ordered into being, by Mokusu Nyojo, the second head priest of Kofuku-ji temple, using stone-arch technique that almost certainly reached Nagasaki from China — the same channel of contact this whole district exists to tell. What a visitor sees walking from Dejima to Shinchii to Oura today is less a single street than three separate answers to the same problem: an island built and later erased, a quarter walled and later burned, and a hillside first refused and then, lot by numbered lot, let go. ¹¹²

Timeline

1634–36	Dejima is ordered built and completed, funded by 25 Nagasaki townsmen, to house Portuguese traders apart from the town. ¹⁶
1637–38	The Shimabara Rebellion is crushed; the Dutch factory supplies cannon to the besieging shogunate army. ²
1639	Portuguese trade is banned; the Portuguese are expelled and Dejima stands empty. ²
1641	The Dutch trading post is moved from Hirado into the vacant Dejima compound. ²⁶
1689	The walled Chinese quarter (Tojin Yashiki) is built in what is now Tate-no-cho. ⁵
1698–1702	Fire destroys Chinese cargo warehouses in town; new warehouses are built on reclaimed land and named Shinchi. ¹
1784	Fire destroys most of the Chinese quarter; Chinese residents are afterward allowed to rebuild in their own style. ⁵¹¹
1859	Nagasaki opens to general foreign residence; the settlement is at first confined to Oura and low ground nearby. ⁸
1861	The settlement is extended to Minamiyamate (35 lots); Thomas Glover takes lot 3 in October. ⁴⁸
1864–65	Oura Church is completed and dedicated; hidden Christians reveal themselves to Father Petitjean weeks later. ¹⁰
1870	The Chinese quarter's remaining buildings burn down for good. ¹¹
1885–1904	River rerouting and harbor reclamation erase Dejima's fan-shaped shoreline entirely. ⁶
1945 (9 Aug)	The atomic bomb detonates over Matsuyama-cho, north of this district; blast and fire damage reach into the old Chinese quarter. ⁹¹¹
1982 (23 Jul)	A cloudburst floods the Nakashima River, destroying or damaging nine of its fourteen historic stone bridges. ¹²

Walking notes

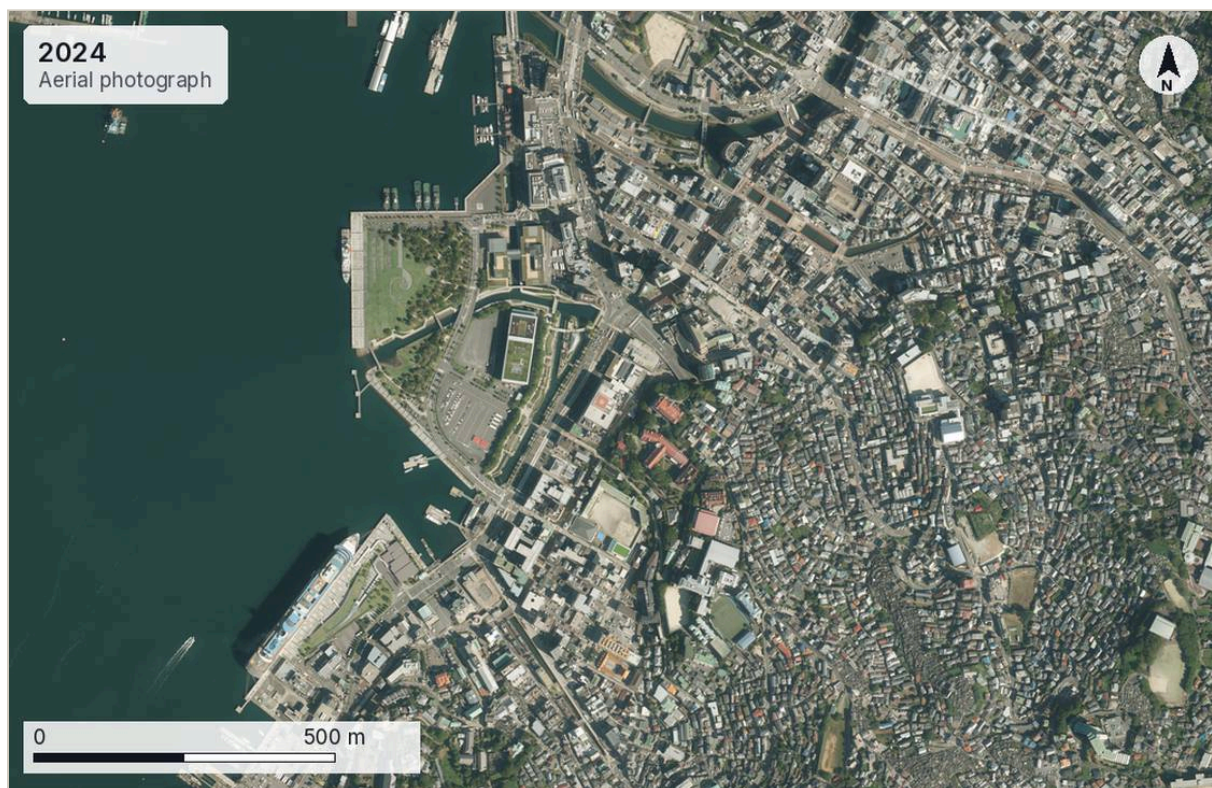
Places to stand and look, in walking order. Straight-line distances only; check today's access and opening before you go.

- 1 Dejima 出島.** The restored west and north ranges, including the reconstructed Kapitan's residence and water gate, sit on the site of the 1636 island; the surrounding city blocks, not water, mark how completely reclamation erased its fan-shaped shoreline by 1904.⁶⁷
- 2 Shinchi Chinatown 新地中華街.** The grid of restaurants and gates stands on the warehouse island the city built after the 1698 fire; the name Shinchi, "new land," is original to that 1702 reclamation.¹
- 3 Tate-no-cho and the Tojin Yashiki remnants 館内町（唐人屋敷跡）.** Look for the small Kannon hall and the Fukken Kaikan's surviving gate and Tenko-do shrine, the last physical fragments of the walled Chinese quarter of 1689–1870.³¹¹
- 4 Meganebashi and the Nakashima River bridges 眼鏡橋・中島川の石橋群.** Japan's oldest surviving stone arch bridge, built in 1634; several of its neighbors downstream were rebuilt after 1982 using stones recovered from the riverbed after that year's flood.¹²
- 5 Oura Church 大浦天主堂.** Japan's oldest standing church, completed in 1864; inside, a plaque marks where hidden Christians from Urakami identified themselves to Father Petitjean in 1865.¹⁰
- 6 Glover Garden, Minamiyamate グラバー園（南山手）.** Thomas Glover's residence occupies lot 3 of the settlement plots surveyed onto this hillside in 1861, the same land a magistrate had refused foreign consuls only months earlier.⁴⁸

The same ground, 1961–1969 and 2024



1961–1969 aerial photograph — GSI Tiles *ort_old10*, cropped and annotated by Japan Time Atlas. North is up; the frame is identical in both images.



2024 annual orthophoto — GSI Tiles *nendophoto2024*, cropped and annotated by Japan Time Atlas. Capture dates within a mosaic can differ from place to place.

How to compare. Anchor on features that rarely move — river banks, rail lines, shrine and temple grounds, main roads — then look for what changed around them. Differences in tone come from film, camera and season, not from the land itself.

The decades in between

Every further GSI series that covers the same frame, oldest first. Each series is a compilation: photographs within one series were taken on different dates, which is why seams and changes of tone can appear inside a frame.



1974-1978 · GSI Tiles *gazo1*, processed

Rivers, shorelines and terraces



Natural landforms as classified by GSI, over a recent aerial photograph in gray. Dark blue outlines mark former river channels.

 Mountain and hill slopes 35%	 Floodplain and coastal plain 19%
 Former water area 11%	 Water 2.5%
 Landslide topography 1.4%	 Plateaus and terraces 0.8%

What the main landforms mean

Mountain and hill slopes (35%). Ridges, valleys and fairly steep ground, including terrace-scarp slopes and volcanic ground. Heavy rain or earthquakes can trigger slope failures, debris flows and landslides.

Floodplain and coastal plain (19%). Low, flat ground of little relief, built from sand and mud left by floods, or former seabed that emerged. River flooding. Ground is softer nearer the coast and shakes somewhat more; liquefaction tendency is strong on coastal plains and somewhat strong on floodplains. Storm surge near the coast.

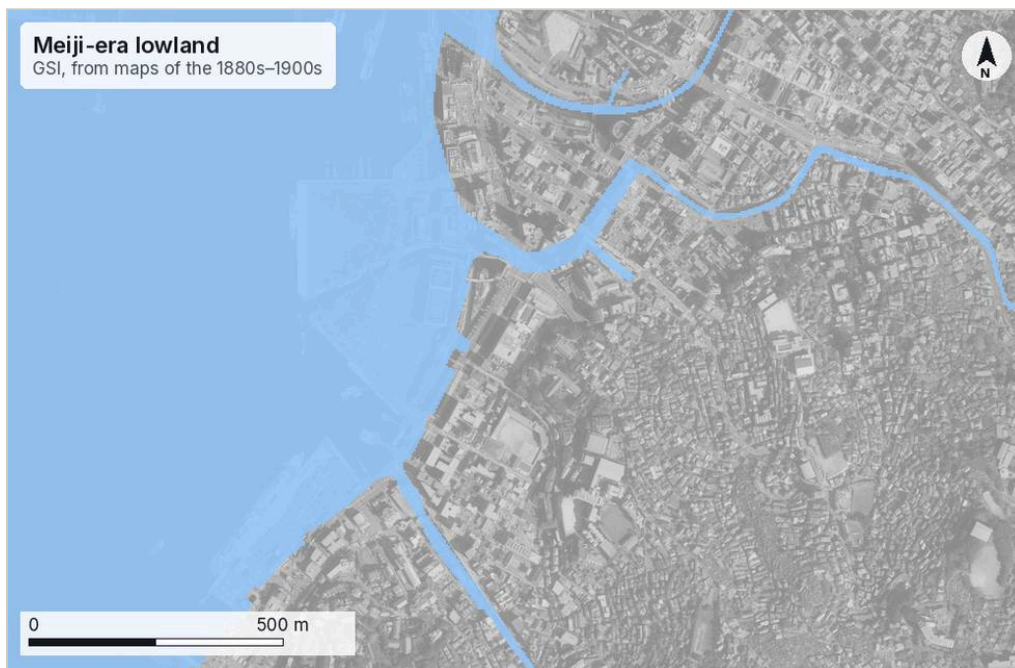
Former water area (11%). Land shown by old maps and aerial photographs to have been sea, lake, pond, reservoir or river, later turned into land. Soft ground: very strong liquefaction tendency where filled, strong where drained. Storm surge near the coast.

Descriptions translated and condensed from GSI's landform-classification legend. They describe tendencies of each landform type, not the condition of any individual plot.

Fill, reclamation and the fields beneath the town



Hatching: man-made ground as classified by GSI. Teal outlines: former sea, river or pond. Dark blue outlines: former river channels.



GSI “Meiji-era lowland” data, traced from topographic maps of the 1880s–1900s; GSI warns that positions can be off by a considerable distance, especially in the Kanto and Kinki regions. Only low, wet or open ground was traced: towns, dry fields and forest of the period are left blank.

Man-made ground

-  Filled and reclaimed land 16%
-  Cut ground 4.8%

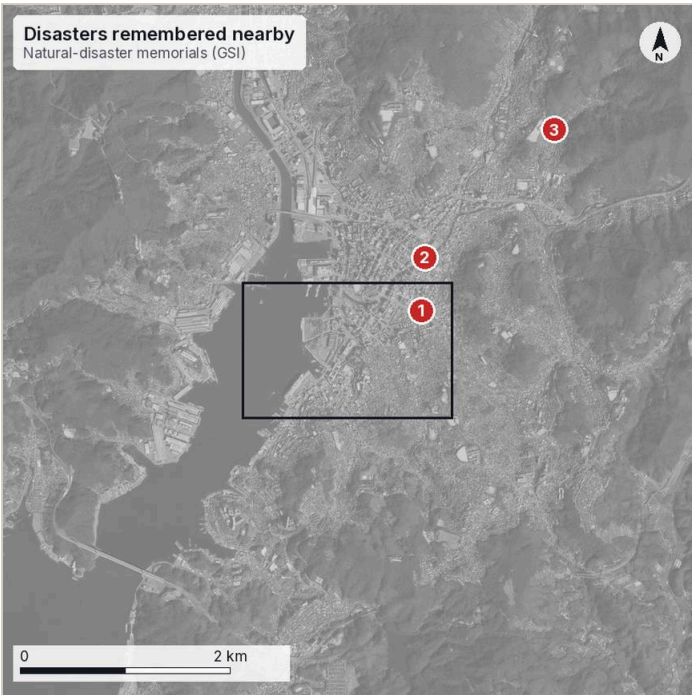
Filled and reclaimed land (16%). Ground raised with fill, land made by dumping soil into the sea, rivers or ponds, or valleys filled in. May flood if not raised enough; on hills, rain or earthquakes can make the fill fail; in lowlands the liquefaction tendency is very strong, especially on filled sea, lake or river beds.

Cut ground (4.8%). Ground made by cutting into slopes of mountains or terrace edges. Depending on the cut slope, heavy rain or earthquakes may bring it down; the ground itself is generally firm.

Meiji-era lowland

-  River, pond or sea 40%

Memorials to natural disasters nearby



Numbered memorials; the black rectangle is the study area of this brief. Frame 7 km across.

Memorial	Disaster	Erected	Distance
1 Memorial tower to the 1982 Nagasaki flood at the site of Shianbashi bridge 長崎大水害記念塔	Heavy rain of July 1982 (Nagasaki flood, 23 Jul 1982) · flood / landslide or debris flow	1984	0.8 km
2 Monument to recovery from the 1982 Nagasaki flood and to friendship with China 水害復興と友好の記念碑	Heavy rain of July 1982 (Nagasaki flood, 23 Jul 1982) · flood / landslide or debris flow	1989	1.1 km
3 Memorial to the victims of the 1982 Nagasaki flood in Narutaki 長崎大水害慰霊碑	Heavy rain of July 1982 (Nagasaki flood, 23 Jul 1982) · flood / landslide or debris flow	2017	2.9 km

What the memorials record

1. **Memorial tower to the 1982 Nagasaki flood at the site of Shianbashi bridge.** In the torrential rain of 23 July 1982 the water here, at the site of Shianbashi bridge, reached 1.57 m, and people, cars and everything else disappeared beneath the muddy flood. Residents rebuilt, and the district regained its liveliness. The tower is topped by a red-seal trading ship sailing towards the future, in praise of that spirit of recovery.
2. **Monument to recovery from the 1982 Nagasaki flood and to friendship with China.** On 23 July 1982 torrential rain left 262 people dead or missing in Nagasaki; of the stone bridges on the Nakashima River, 6 were washed away and 3 half-destroyed. The monument was made in China, which helped build the river's stone bridges; it shows a Chinese boy and a Japanese girl together taming a dragon that brings wind and rain.
3. **Memorial to the victims of the 1982 Nagasaki flood in Narutaki.** Shortly after 5 pm on 23 July 1982 a violent thundery downpour of around 100 mm struck, and a massive debris flow in the Narutaki area left 23 people dead and 1 missing. The memorial honours them and passes on the lesson so that such a disaster is never repeated.

Source: GSI Natural Disaster Memorials (自然災害伝承碑). English names and notes are Japan Time Atlas translations and summaries of GSI's Japanese descriptions; the memorials' own inscriptions may say more. "Erected" is the year GSI records for the monument.

Sources

1. 香月薫平 著 (Katsuki Kunpei), *長崎地名考 下之巻* [A study of Nagasaki place names, vol. 2], 1893; NDL frame 29. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/766701/1/29> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: The 1634 shogunate order and the 25 townsmen who built Dejima for the Portuguese; the 1698 fire and 1698–1702 reclamation of Shinchi for Chinese cargo warehouses, and the origin of the name.
2. 村上直次郎 著 (Murakami Naojiro), *日蘭三百年の親交* [Three hundred years of Japan-Dutch friendship], 1915; NDL frames 25, 26, 27, 29, 33. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/954621/1/27> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: The Shimabara Rebellion and the 1639 expulsion of the Portuguese; the Dutch factory's move from Hirado to Dejima in 1641; the island's physical layout and the confined daily life of its Dutch residents.
3. 長崎県 [編] (Nagasaki Prefecture), *長崎県史跡名勝天然記念物 第7輯* [Historic sites, scenic spots and natural monuments of Nagasaki Prefecture, vol. 7], 1931; NDL frames 79, 86, 94. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/1143715/1/79> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: A 1931 survey of surviving Chinese-quarter remains: the Ghost Hall, the Kannon hall in Tate-no-cho, and the compound's surviving inner gate.
4. 斎藤古稀祝賀会 編, 斎藤先生古稀祝賀記念論文集 (田中「地図より観たる長崎居留地の変遷」) [Festschrift for Professor Saito (article: Changes in the Nagasaki settlement as seen through maps, by Tanaka)], 1937; NDL frame 412. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/1228963/1/412> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: Pre-settlement Minamiyamate (only a shrine, Myogyo-ji and a guard post); the reclamation of the Oura inlet's banks for the settlement; how Dejima and Shinchi were linked to the town by single bridges.
5. *唐人屋敷の歴史* [History of the Tojin Yashiki (Chinese quarter)], 長崎市 (City of Nagasaki). <https://www.city.nagasaki.lg.jp/page/2242.html>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Construction in 1688–89 to contain Chinese traders and prevent smuggling; size and layout; the 1784 fire and 1870 destruction.
6. *出島の歴史* [History of Dejima], 出島復元整備事業部 (Dejima restoration project office). <https://nagasaki-dejima.jp/history/>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Dejima's completion in 1636; the Portuguese and Dutch periods; the 1885 river rerouting and the disappearance of the fan shape by 1904.
7. *復元整備事業* [Restoration project], 出島復元整備事業部 (Dejima restoration project office). <https://nagasaki-dejima.jp/restoration-work/>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The 1922 historic-site designation, the 1996 start of full-scale restoration, the buildings rebuilt in phase one, and the long-term goal of surrounding the island with water again.
8. *南山手の誕生* [The birth of Minamiyamate], グラバー園 (Glover Garden). <https://glover-garden.jp/secret-stories/story-060/>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The 1859–61 extension of the settlement to Minamiyamate, consul George S. Morrison's role, and Thomas Glover's 1861 lot.
9. 11時2分 [11:02 a.m.], 長崎市 平和推進部 (City of Nagasaki, Peace Promotion Division). https://nagasakipeace.jp/search/about_abm/scene/1102.html, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The time, altitude and address of the atomic bomb's detonation over Matsuyama-cho on 9 August 1945.
10. *歴史* [History], NPO法人 世界遺産長崎チャーチトラスト (World Heritage Nagasaki Church Trust). <https://churchtrust.jp/about-oura/history>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Oura Church's construction and dedication dates, the 1865 discovery of hidden Christians, its 1879 rebuilding, and its National Treasure and UNESCO status.
11. *唐人屋敷跡* [The Tojin Yashiki ruins], 長崎新地中華街振興協同組合 (Nagasaki Shinchi Chinatown association). <https://www.nagasaki-chinatown.com/sansaku/yashikiato/>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The 1689 construction date; the surviving Doshin-do, Kannon-do and Tenko-do shrines; wartime damage to the Fukken Kaikan (Fujian assembly hall) from the atomic bomb.
12. *長崎・眼鏡橋復元の物語* [The story of the restoration of Nagasaki's Meganebashi], ミツカン水の文化センター・機関誌『水の文化』47号 (Mitsukan Water Culture Center). <https://www.mizu.gr.jp/kikanshi/no47/05.html>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Meganebashi's 1634 construction by Mokusu Nyojo; the 1982 flood's rainfall record and bridge damage; the 1980s campaign to restore rather than remove the damaged bridges.

Further reading

- *長崎外国人居留地の研究* (菱谷武平 著, 1988) — The standard scholarly study of the Nagasaki foreign settlement, cited by name in this dossier's own harvest; NDL-premises only but the fullest available treatment. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/13265692> (NDL premises only)
- *長崎唐人屋敷* (山本紀綱 著, 1983) — A dedicated history of the Chinese quarter with far more detail than this dossier could verify from internet-open frames alone. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/12280251> (NDL individual digital transmission (registered users))
- *南山手の洋館：伝統的建造物群保存対策事業報告書* (長崎市教育委員会管理部文化課 [編], 1977) — The city's own survey of Minamiyamate's Western-style houses, building by building; a natural source for anyone researching a specific address. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/12873052> (NDL individual digital transmission (registered users))
- *長崎異人街誌* (浜崎国男 著, 1978) — A history of Nagasaki's various foreign quarters together, useful for comparing Dejima, the Chinese quarter and the post-1859 settlement in one place. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/9770361> (NDL individual digital transmission (registered users))

- 国指定史跡出島和蘭商館跡範囲確認調査報告書（1986） — An archaeological boundary–confirmation survey of the Dejima site, useful for anyone wanting the excavation evidence behind the restoration project. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/12240773> (NDL individual digital transmission (registered users))

Where a Deep Research request would go next

- **The Dutch East India Company's own Dejima factory diaries (day-by-day) beyond the translated excerpts read for this dossier** — Nagasaki Prefectural Library and Nagasaki Museum of History and Culture, which hold Murakami Naojiro's translation series; the originals are in the National Archives of the Netherlands (Nationaal Archief), The Hague, VOC archive. Search the Nationaal Archief's online VOC inventory by Dejima/Nagasaki factory year; Japanese translated volumes can be requested at the prefectural library's local-history desk.
- **Individual leasehold and building records for a specific Minamiyamate or Oura settlement lot** — Nagasaki City Archives (長崎歴史文化博物館 historical records division) and the Nagasaki District Legal Affairs Bureau's closed land registers. Request old land registers (旧土地台帳) by lot number; the museum's archives division can advise on surviving settlement-council records.
- **Family and business records of the Chinese merchant houses of the Tojin Yashiki and later Shinchi** — Nagasaki Museum of History and Culture and the Fukken Kaikan (Fujian Assembly Hall) itself, which may hold its own society records. Contact the museum's research division; the Chinatown association (S11) can advise on approaching the assembly halls directly.
- **US Strategic Bombing Survey ground-damage mapping for the area south of the hypocenter, including the old Chinese quarter** — US National Archives (NARA), RG 243 (US Strategic Bombing Survey) and RG 77 (Manhattan Engineer District). Search the NARA online catalog by Nagasaki and 1945; many blast-damage maps and photographs are already digitized.
- **Administrative and engineering records of the 1982 flood and the Nakashima River bridge restorations** — Nagasaki Prefectural Archives and the Nagasaki City river-engineering section. Search prefectural archive catalogues for 長崎大水害 (1982) and 中島川 改修 administrative files; request reading-room access in advance.

Caveats

- Casualty figures for the 1982 Nagasaki flood vary: this dossier's companion Basic brief gives the city's own figure of 262 dead or missing, while a specialist water-history source used here rounds the toll to "about 300"; both describe the same disaster.
- The distance from the atomic bomb's hypocenter to Dejima given in this dossier (roughly four kilometers) is this writer's own calculation from the hypocenter's published coordinates and this district's study-area center, not a single published "distance to Dejima" figure.
- Dejima's founding is sometimes dated to 1634 (when the shogunate ordered it built) and sometimes to 1636 (when construction finished); this dossier uses both dates for what they each describe.
- One further-reading item, a 1997 architectural study of the Tojin Yashiki, appears in NDL's full-text search as internet-accessible but could not actually be opened through NDL Lab in this session, so it is omitted rather than cited.

Digitised books are cited, not reproduced: the page frames let you open the same page in the NDL Digital Collections. Aerial photographs, landform and memorial data: GSI, processed by Japan Time Atlas. This experimental edition was checked against its cited sources on 2026-09-28 but has not had independent fact-checking.